

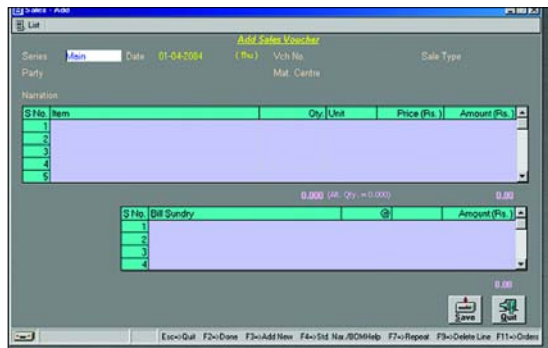
track of the service tax, which is a helpful option for the service industry.

On the whole, atACC has a very good feature set, but misses out on ease of use, and a few basic features that would make the accounting experience easier.

BUSY Business Accounting Professional Edition

www.busyinfotech.com

BUSY works only at the 800 x 600 resolution, which is irritating. However, the software is easy to set up and has an easy-to-understand interface. There are only a few noticeable differences between BUSY and the rest. BUSY's sale purchase form is a little more out of place than in other software. It has an option that allows you to easily track receivables from parties or forms issued for purchase.



A highlight of the BUSY package is a very good analysis of sales and purchase

One highlight of the package is a very good analysis of sales and purchase. The package lets you search for individual options such as transaction, item and amount. Other features in terms of accounting and inventory maintenance are similar to those in other accounting packages.

EX Personal Accountant

www.tcs.com/O_products/expersonal/products_expersonal.htm

This accounting solution has a very easy installation procedure and interface navigation. Setting up your account is easy as well. You can set up accounts under different groups, unlike in other software, where you have to first define a group, and then go to ledger accounts and define accounts under that group. Apart from the standard feature set, sales tax handling for purchases and sales are done through the Charges Module, the setting up of



EX gives you the option to adjust open debits and credits

which is also a snap. You have the flexibility to apply charges on the invoice as per the requirement—other software offer predefined fields which you have to select.

The software gives you the option to adjust open debits and credits, which is useful for maintaining receivables or payables. This is a plus point, as such features are only found in ERP packages and not in accounting packages.

EX Personal Accountant also gives you the option of generating various MIS reports such as Income-Expense analysis, Sales Purchase analysis, Cost Centre, Account and Item-wise analysis. The software also has a feature that calculates the interest for you.

One more unique feature is the Customer folder, which gives you an overview of all transactions with the specified customer, such as sales, receipts, sales returns, opening debit/credit, etc. The Cost Centre that is present in most software is called Budget Variance in EX Personal Accountant, but it only allows you to allocate budgets for different activities, and not plan for contingencies.

You can export reports to the MS Word and Excel formats, and the software has full support for dot matrix, inkjet and laser printers.

Expert Quick Accounting 3.0

www.compubrain.net

Unless you run your screen at a resolution of 800 x 600, this software will irritate you from the moment you install it. It automatically forces your screen resolution to 800 x 600 mode. As long as the program runs, you cannot change the display back to normal, even from the system display properties.

Stock valuation options in Expert Quick Accounting 3.0 range from LIFO, FIFO, Cost, HIFO and Weighted Average. The Account Receivable and Payable option in Expert Quick Accounting 3.0 is limited, and does not offer a bill-wise outstanding amount.

The software is not user-friendly, and is not recommended if you are running accounting software for the first time. When compared to the other software, Expert Quick Accounting seems to be overpriced, especially for the plain features it offers.

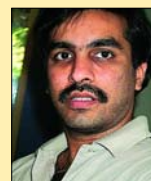
Simply Accounting Pro 2003

www.simplyaccounting.com/asia/

This was the only software in this category to offer Web store integration. This is a function that allows a company to set up a Web site for selling goods, and automatically add all orders made online to your books. This feature is a must-have for all online

Our Expert Panel

Although we have a battery of technology experts right here at Digit, they're not quite professionally trained to test accounting software. So we brought in a couple of accounts experts to help us test software the lineup. Here's a little information about them.



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Vipul Shah,
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Shah is a Chartered Accountant and consultant who writes regularly on technology and related issues for various publications. He assists companies in testing pre-release products, and also reviews released products. He can be reached at digit@vipulshah.com